



Amazon Interview Experience

Amazon is an **American multinational technology** company focusing on e-commerce, cloud computing, online advertising, digital streaming, and artificial intelligence. It is considered one of the **Big Five American technology companies**, alongside Alphabet (parent company of Google), Apple, Meta (parent company of Facebook) and Microsoft. It is a product-based company and one of the infamous **MAANG** companies.

Role Offered: SDE-2m Intern

Stipend: 1,10,000 INR + 400 USD per month

Sequence of selection: PPT, Online Assessment, Technical Interview

Online Assessment:

It consisted of two **coding questions** and a work **personality test**.

- Coding Question - 2(A total of 70 minutes)
- Personality test – No time constraint (But compulsory to complete)

The question pattern for the online assessment would change every year. This year it was only coding round whereas previously they would ask coding questions along with some technical questions. So, prepare yourself for both **coding questions** and **MCQ's**.

The online Assessment was conducted in **HackerRank** platform.

Coding Question 1:

Given an array of strings which consists of the names of the websites that a user visits. The task is to return an array of strings in the order such that the websites that are recently visited should appear first and also the array must only contain distinct elements.

Sample Testcase:

Str = ["Amazon", "Facebook", "YouTube", "Twitter", "Facebook", "Amazon", "YouTube"]

Output:

Ans = ["YouTube", "Amazon", "Facebook", "Twitter"]

Each got a different set of questions and mostly everything was easy.

Coding Question 2:

Given a binary string where some positions are marked as x other than 1's and 0's. And the defect rate is the number of positions in which the two consecutive characters are different. The task is to minimize the defect rate by filling the positions which are marked as x by either 0 or 1 and return the defect rate.

Sample Testcase:

Str = "0100x011x10xx"

Output: 4**Explanation:**

Replace the first x by 0, the second x by 1 and the remaining x's by 0 so you will get "0100001111000" and the number of positions in which the two consecutive characters are different are **4**.

Then a personality test was conducted which mostly had questions which was asked to test our thinking ability and how we approach a problem. I don't think it was included in the marking scheme.

Based on this Online Assessment, 20 people were shortlisted for the next round.

Technical Interview: (1 hour)

The interview was conducted in Amazon's chime platform. We were provided an amazon chime link for the meeting.

In the interview, we had an introduction where each of us took a turn introducing ourselves. In this interview, you wouldn't have any HR round to talk about your strengths. So, when you introduce yourself, tell them your technical strengths and what projects you have worked on. Present yourself in a pleasing way. Then you would be asked to share your screen and use **LiveCode** to code your questions.

1. The first question was to print all the cousins of a given node in a binary tree whose siblings are not prime.

The question is similar to the below one:

<https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/print-cousins-of-a-given-node-in-binary-tree>

Initially I was asked the approach and then asked to code the same from scratch. I told them the brute force solution and they asked me to optimize it and then I told the optimized answer. Once they were satisfied with my solution they asked me to code the same. Then they enquired me about the time and space complexities.

2. Find an equilibrium index in an array where the sum of elements to the left and right are equal.

The question is similar to the below one:

<https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/equilibrium-index-of-an-array>

I was asked the approach first and then asked to code the same. This time they asked me to code the brute force solution and then they asked me to optimize the brute force approach and then code the optimized approach for this problem. Then they enquired me about the time and space complexities.

With that the interview got over.

The result was announced the next day and I was one of the two members who got the offer.

Tips:

- Regular practice is important. Solve questions in **Leetcode**, **GeeksForGeeks** and **HackerRank**.
- I followed **C.O.D.E. resources** and **takeUForward YouTube channel** for my preparation on topics like Trees, Graphs, DP and Recursion.

- If you are not confident with **DBMS, OS** and **OOPS**, then prepare for them simultaneously because you won't be having much time between the online test and the interview.
- Aptitude is as important as DSA. At least start learning aptitude two weeks before your online test.
- Even though I was not asked about my projects, in every interview they will ask about your projects, and they might ask you about the database structure and all. So be prepared to answer any questions related to your projects.
- For any DSA question give them the brute force approach and don't jump to the optimized answer directly. The interviewers are mostly interested in your thought process rather than your code.

In the end, after all the preparation go through **the 14 leadership requirements from Amazon** (just in case, interviewer may check) and **STAR** approach.

All the very best!!!

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